

GNOME Desktop Cheat-Sheet

GNOME desktop cheat-sheet

Stock Fedora 44 GNOME – no theming, no extensions beyond Fedora’s own **background-logo**. Reverted to defaults 2026-07-23. The old Windows-like rice (dash-to-panel, ArcMenu, Nord colors) is still in this repo behind the **gnome-nord** script if it’s ever wanted back; see [Recovery](#).

Overview & apps

Key	Action
Super	Activities overview (windows + workspaces + search)
Type after Super	Search apps/files, Enter to launch
Super + A	Application grid
Alt + F2	Run-command prompt
Top-left hot corner	Overview (mouse)

Favorites live in the dash on the left of the overview – right-click an app to pin. Add custom launch hotkeys in Settings > Keyboard > Custom Shortcuts.

Windows

Key	Action
Alt + Tab	Switch between applications (grouped)
Alt + `	Switch between windows of the current app
Super + Left/Right	Snap window to half screen (or drag to edge)
Super + Up	Maximize (or drag to top edge)
Super + Down	Unmaximize / restore
Super + H	Minimize (“hide”)
Alt + F4	Close window
Alt + F7 / Alt + F8	Move / resize with the keyboard
F11	Fullscreen (app-dependent)

Workspaces

Key	Action
Super + Page Up / Page Down	Previous / next workspace
Super + Shift + Page Up / Page Down	Move window to prev/next workspace
Ctrl + Alt + Left / Right	Previous / next workspace (alternate)
3-finger touchpad swipe up	Overview (all windows + workspaces)
4-finger touchpad swipe left/right	Switch workspace

Media / system

Volume, brightness, and media keys are handled natively by GNOME. System menu (network, bluetooth, battery, power off): top-right of the top bar. Lock screen: **Super + Shift + L**.

Terminal apps

Command	Action
<code>y</code>	yazi (in any terminal) – <code>cds</code> to wherever you exited
<code>yazi</code>	yazi without the <code>cd-on-exit</code> behavior

Shell power-ups (zsh)

All emulator-agnostic – these work in `gnome-terminal`, over SSH, and any other terminal. Every hook is guarded, so the same `.zshrc` is safe on a minimal box. | Key / Command | Action | |—| | **Ctrl-R** | Fuzzy search command history (`fzf`) | | **Ctrl-T** | Fuzzy-pick a file/path into the current command (`fzf`) | | **Alt-C** | Fuzzy `cd` into a subdirectory (`fzf`) | | **z <part>** | Jump to a frecent directory by fragment (`zoxide`) | | **zi** | Interactive `zoxide` directory picker | | Right arrow / **Ctrl-E** | Accept the greyed-out autosuggestion | | **ll** / **la** | `eza long` / long-all listing (git status + icons) | | **lt** | `eza tree`, 2 levels deep | | **lg** | `lazygit` (git TUI) | | **zellij** | terminal multiplexer (tmux alternative) | | `direnv allow` | Trust an `.envrc` so its `env` loads on `cd` |

Installed toolbox

Everything added this session, in brief. Run any of these from a terminal.

CLI / shell

Tool	What it does
<code>fzf</code>	Fuzzy finder; powers <code>Ctrl-R</code> / <code>Ctrl-T</code> / <code>Alt-C</code> above
<code>fd</code>	Fast, friendly <code>find</code> replacement
<code>zoxide</code>	<code>z</code> – jump to directories by frequency
<code>eza</code>	Modern <code>ls</code> (git status, icons, tree)
<code>bat</code>	<code>cat</code> with syntax highlighting + paging
<code>git-delta</code>	Pretty side-by-side git diffs (wired into git)
<code>lazygit (lg)</code>	Full-screen git TUI
<code>zellij</code>	Terminal multiplexer (panes/tabs; tmux alternative)
<code>procs</code>	Modern <code>ps</code>
<code>hyperfine</code>	Command benchmarking tool
<code>ncdu</code>	Interactive disk-usage browser
<code>tealdeer (tldr)</code>	Fast, example-first man pages
<code>yq</code>	Like <code>jq</code> , but for YAML
<code>glow</code>	Render Markdown in the terminal
<code>chafa</code>	Show images as terminal graphics

Dev

Tool	What it does
<code>nvim</code>	Neovim editor
<code>just</code>	Command runner (a saner <code>make</code> for tasks)
<code>direnv</code>	Auto-load per-project <code>env</code> from <code>.envrc</code>

Tool	What it does
distrobox	Run other distros' tools in containers
shellcheck	Lints shell scripts for bugs
http	HTTPIe – human-friendly curl

Files / transfer / backup

Tool	What it does
croc	Send files between machines via a code phrase
rclone	Sync to/from cloud storage (rsync for clouds)
restic	Fast encrypted snapshot backups
aria2c	Multi-connection downloader
syncthing	Continuous peer-to-peer folder sync
trash-put	Send files to the trash instead of <code>rm</code>

Network / security

Tool	What it does
nmap	Network/port scanner
wireshark	Packet capture + analysis (GUI)
gping	Ping with a live graph
age	Simple modern file encryption
testdisk / photorec	Recover lost partitions / deleted files
lynis	Local security-hardening audit

System / hardware

Tool	What it does
nvtop	GPU usage monitor (watch the RTX 5070)
powertop	Power draw analysis + tunables
s-tui	Stress test + live CPU temp/freq TUI

Gaming

Tool	What it does
mangohud	In-game FPS/perf overlay (<code>mangohud <game></code>)
goverlay	GUI to configure MangoHud
gamescope	Micro-compositor for games (scaling, framecap)
Lutris	Launcher for non-Steam / Windows games
Heroic	Epic / GOG / Amazon games launcher (Flatpak)
ProtonUp-Qt	Manage Proton-GE versions (Flatpak)

Terminal toys

Tool	What it does
<code>cmatrix</code>	Matrix rain
<code>cava</code>	Audio spectrum visualizer
<code>asciiquarium</code>	ASCII aquarium
<code>cowsay</code> / <code>lolcat</code> / <code>figlet</code>	ASCII cow / rainbow pipe / big text

GUI apps (Flatpak)

OBS Studio (recording/streaming), Krita (painting), GIMP (photo editing), Inkscape (vector), Blender (3D), Audacity (audio), HandBrake (video transcode), Obsidian (notes), Bitwarden (passwords), Flameshot (screenshot annotate), LocalSend (AirDrop-style transfer).

yazi keybinds

Key	Action
<code>j</code> / <code>k</code> or arrows	Move down / up
<code>h</code> / <code>l</code> or arrows	Parent dir / enter dir
<code>H</code> / <code>L</code>	Back / forward in history
<code>gg</code> / <code>G</code>	Top / bottom
<code>gh</code>	Go home (~)
<code>gc</code>	Go to <code>~/.config</code>
<code>gd</code>	Go to <code>~/Downloads</code>
<code><Space></code>	Toggle selection on current file
<code>v</code> / <code>V</code>	Visual select mode / visual unset mode
<code>Ctrl+a</code> / <code>Ctrl+r</code>	Select all / invert selection
<code>y</code> / <code>x</code> / <code>p</code> / <code>P</code>	Yank (copy) / cut / paste / paste (overwrite)
<code>d</code> / <code>D</code>	Trash / permanently delete
<code>a</code>	Create file (end with <code>/</code> for a directory)
<code>r</code>	Rename
<code>o</code> / <code>Enter</code>	Open
<code>O</code> / <code>Shift+Enter</code>	Open interactively (pick app)
<code>.</code>	Toggle hidden files
<code>/</code> / <code>?</code>	Find next / previous
<code>s</code> / <code>S</code>	Search by name (fd) / by content (ripgrep)
<code>f</code>	Filter files
<code>tt</code>	New tab in current dir
<code>1-9</code>	Switch to tab N
<code>[</code> / <code>]</code>	Previous / next tab
<code>,</code> then <code>m/a/s/e/n</code>	Sort by mtime / alphabetical / size / extension / natural (Shift = reverse)
<code>w</code>	Task manager
<code>~</code> or <code>F1</code>	Help (full keymap, searchable)
<code>q</code>	Quit

GPU offload

Run any app on the NVIDIA dGPU instead of the AMD iGPU (GNOME always runs on AMD, since it drives the panel):

```
dgpu-run <command>
# e.g.
dgpu-run flatpak run org.prismlauncher.PrismLauncher
```

Songs of Syx mods

The game runs its Windows build under Proton and does not see Steam Workshop subscriptions on its own, so the launcher's MODS tab shows up empty. `syx-mods-sync` symlinks every subscribed mod into the Proton prefix so the launcher lists them:

```
syx-mods-sync      # safe to re-run; prints what it linked
```

It runs automatically on game launch via Steam launch options (`syx-mods-sync; %command%`), so a new subscription is there next time you start. After subscribing you still have to tick the mod in the launcher's MODS tab, and mods must be enabled *before* starting a world.

Mods are linked, not copied, so Workshop updates apply with no action. Unsubscribing leaves a dead link that the next run cleans up. Hand-placed mod folders are real directories and are never touched.

WiFi

GNOME's system menu (top-right of the taskbar) lists and connects to networks. The `wifi` script still works from any terminal:

```
wifi                # interactive picker
wifi "GC Public"    # connect straight to a named network
```

Saved networks reconnect without a prompt; new ones ask for a password. On a captive portal you'll associate but have no route out until you open any `http://` page and sign in.

Recovery

The login screen is GDM, stock and unthemed (Fedora's default). SDDM and its Nord theme are still installed but inactive.

- **GNOME session won't start / crashes at login:** from a TTY, check `journalctl --user -b -u org.gnome.Shell@wayland.service` (or `journalctl -b -p err`). `Ctrl+Alt+F1` (or `F2`) back to the graphical screen.
- **Session hung:** `loginctl terminate-user cross` from a TTY force-kills it and drops back to the login screen.
- **Want the old Windows-like rice back:** `stow gtk && gnome-nord`, then log out/in. That re-enables dash-to-panel, ArcMenu and appindicator, restores the Nord colors and the per-window Alt-Tab, and re-applies the generated wallpaper. If ArcMenu is gone entirely (e.g. after a GNOME major upgrade breaks compatibility), reinstall the matching version from extensions.gnome.org (`gnome-extensions install <zip>`).
- **Desperate fallback session:** pick "GNOME Classic" at the login screen's session picker – ugly but always works. Normal logins should use plain "GNOME".